

— WEEKLY BULLETIN —

ROSH HASHANA 5787

11–14 September 2026 · 29 Elul 5786–3 Tishri 5787

WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT?
TRADITIONAL, BUT EGALITARIAN.

Everyone welcome, all included.

TIMES FOR POUGHKEEPSIE, NY (41.70° N, 73.92° W)

CANDLE LIGHTING6:54 pm

Erev Rosh Hashana and Shabbat, Friday, 11 September · 18 minutes to sunset

SUNSET7:12 pm

Friday, 11 September

CANDLE LIGHTING, SECOND DAY7:46 pm

Saturday, 12 September, after the first day ends · from a flame lit before the festival

ROSH HASHANA ENDS7:44 pm

Sunday, 13 September · Habdala

FAST OF GEDALIA BEGINS5:10 am

Monday, 14 September · dawn

FAST OF GEDALIA ENDS7:42 pm

Monday, 14 September · nightfall

SERVICE TIMES FOR KEHILLAH KEDOSHAH ZIKHRON ZVI

DAY I — FRIDAY NIGHT

ʿARBIT7:00 pm

Evening service

DAY I — SATURDAY MORNING

ZEMIROT10:00 am

Morning Blessings

PESUKEI DEZIMRAH10:15 am

Psalms

SHAHRIT10:30 am

Morning Service

SEFER12:00 noon

Reading of the Torah and Haftarah

MUSAF1:00 pm

Additional Service

CONCLUSION OF SERVICES & KIDDUSH2:30 pm

You can come just for this if prayer and Torah reading is not your thing

Please feel free to come and go as you wish.

No Shofar blowing on Shabbat.

DAY I — SATURDAY AFTERNOON

MINHAH5:00 pm

DAY II — SATURDAY NIGHT

ʿARBIT7:45 pm

Evening service

DAY II — SUNDAY MORNING

ZEMIROT10:00 am

Morning Blessings

PESUKEI DEZIMRAH10:15 am

Psalms

SHAHRIT10:30 am

Morning Service

SEFER12:00 noon

Reading of the Torah and Haftarah

SHOFAR SERVICE1:00 pm

MUSAF1:30 pm

Additional Service

CONCLUSION OF SERVICES & KIDDUSH2:30 pm

You can come just for this if prayer and Torah reading is not your thing

Please feel free to come and go as you wish.

DAY II — SUNDAY AFTERNOON

MINHAH5:00 pm



TORAH READING & HAFTARAH

Rosh Hashana, first day (on Shabbat), Genesis 21:1–34; maftir Numbers 29:1–6.

Haftarah: I Samuel 1:1–2:10. Ashkenazim and Sephardim read the same passage.

Rosh Hashana, second day, Genesis 22:1–24; maftir Numbers 29:1–6.

Haftarah: Jeremiah 31:2–20. Ashkenazim and Sephardim read the same passage.

On the first day we read of Sarah. The Eternal took note of her as promised, and at the set time she bore a son. Abraham circumcises Isaac at eight days and makes a great feast at his weaning. Sarah asks that Hagar and Ishmael be sent away, and in the wilderness of Beer-sheba God hears the cry of the boy, opens Hagar’s eyes to a well, and promises that he too will become a great nation. Abraham then makes a pact with Abimelech at Beer-sheba. The maftir from Numbers names the day one of sounding the shofar.

Hannah goes up year after year to Shiloh with Elkanah, taunted for her childlessness and unable to eat. She prays without a sound, and Eli, watching her lips, mistakes her for a drunken woman; she answers that she has been pouring out her heart. Eli blesses her, she goes home, and Samuel is born. When he is weaned she brings him to Shiloh and lends him to the service of the Eternal. Her song follows: the bows of the mighty are broken, the hungry are fed, the poor are raised from the dust and seated among nobles.

IN THE WEEK AHEAD

Saturday, 12 September — Rosh Hashana.

Sunday, 13 September — Rosh Hashana, second day.

Monday, 14 September — Fast of Gedalia.

Saturday, 19 September — Shabbat Shuba.

KIDDUSH

Kiddush follows the service. Meals are dairy and vegetarian.

We meet in a private home; our address is shared by message. If prayer is not your thing, you are welcome to join only for the Kiddush and the company.

To RSVP and to register food issues and avoidances, kindly contact the Congregation’s secretary at kehillatzikhronzvi@gmail.com by Thursday night at 10:00 pm

KKZZ is free to join, there is no membership fee, and we never solicit contributions from members, students, parents or alumni. [You may, if you wish, sponsor a meal or contribute to the work of the Congregation.](#) Kehillah Kedoshah Zikhron Zvi is a tax-exempt charitable organization under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code; offerings are tax-deductible to the extent permitted by law.

REFLECTIONS ON ROSH HASHANA

HALAKHA

The Rambam rules that the mitzvah of the day is to hear the shofar, learned from the Torah’s words, *a day of sounding shall it be for you*.¹ When the first day falls on Shabbat, as it does this year, no shofar is sounded anywhere. The blowing itself is forbidden only as *shebut*, a rabbinic restriction, and the Rambam says a commandment of the Torah would ordinarily override it. The Sages nonetheless decreed otherwise, lest someone carry the shofar through the street to a skilled blower. All are obligated, and not all are skilled.² Among us that *all* is read plainly: women and men alike hear the shofar and sound it. So on Sunday morning we hear the blasts — thirty after the Torah is returned, the blower saying the blessing to hear the shofar and *shehehiyanu*, then further blasts within Musaf at Malkhuyyot, Zikhronot and Shofarot.³

Keter Shem Tob gathers the customs for the long teru’a after Musaf. Rav Sa’adia Gaon gave the reason as confounding the accuser; Rav Hai Gaon said it was no custom at all, only that individuals who had not heard would blow once the service ended. Mahzor Vitry has a bare teru’a, without tekia or shebarim; in Vienna they sounded full sets three times over. The Rambam’s own order of prayer does not mention it. Keter Shem Tob offers its own reason: the Shekhina rests among those who pray, and as they part we sound one teru’a — *God has ascended with a teru’a*.⁴

1. Mishneh Torah, Shofar, Sukkah and Lulav 1:1 2. Mishneh Torah, Shofar, Sukkah and Lulav 2:6 3. Mishneh Torah, Shofar, Sukkah and Lulav 3:10 4. Keter Shem Tob, vol. 6, pp. 202–203

AGGADA

Hannah stands at Shiloh and prays, and the verse says she was speaking upon her heart; her lips moved, her voice was not heard. Rashi explains that Eli took her for drunk because people were not accustomed to praying without sound.¹ Radak, following the Targum, reads it differently: she gathered her heart into the prayer.² The midrash teaches that Sarah, Rachel and Hannah were remembered on Rosh Hashana.³ That is why we read of Sarah in the morning and Hannah after her. Zikkaron is the day’s own word, and it begins with prayer nobody else could hear.

1. Rashi on I Samuel 1:13 2. Radak on I Samuel 1:13 3. Bereshit Rabbah 73:1

GREETINGS OF THE NEW YEAR

שָׁנָה טוֹבָה וְמִתְקָה

HEBREW — *Shana toba u-metuka* · A good and sweet year

אָ גוט געבענטשט יאָר

YIDDISH — *A gut gebentsht yor* · A good, blessed year

Años muchos y buenos

LADINO — Many good years

كل عام وأنتم بخير

JUDEO-ARABIC — *Kull ‘am wa-antum bi-khayr* · May you be well with every year

سال نو مبارک

JUDEO-PERSIAN — *Sal-e now mobarak* · A blessed new year

Che siamo il capo e non la coda

JUDEO-ITALIAN (ITALKIT) — We should be the head and not the tail

Καλή χρονιά

JUDEO-GREEK — *Kali chronia* · A good year



Torah readings and calendar data by Hebcal.com (CC BY 4.0). Times are computed for Poughkeepsie by the congregation’s luach; the end of Shabbat follows the convention of Congregation Shearith Israel, New York.



KEHILLAH KEDOSHAH ZIKHRON ZVI

A traditional egalitarian home minyan in the Hudson Valley, in the Western Sephardic liturgical tradition.

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